

Folk, world, and roots

Every country has its own indigenous musical culture. The rise of international travel and technological advances has made all kinds of music available to us—inspiring musicians to blend traditional melodies, rhythms, and instruments to create exciting new sounds.

SEE ALSO

◀ 32–33 Compound time

◀ 40–41 Syncopation and swing

◀ 80–85 Other scales

Dance music

216–219 ▶

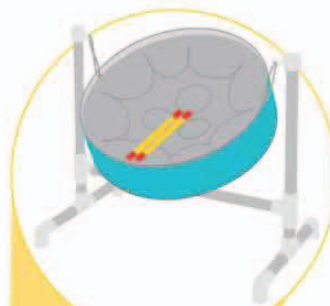
Music of the Caribbean

The driving rhythms of African music have contributed to the development of Caribbean music, including Cuban salsa, Jamaican reggae, and the calypso of Trinidad and Tobago. Often associated with celebrations, it is heavily syncopated, with prominent percussion, engaging vocals, guitars, trumpets, and saxophones.



△ Calypso rhythm

Often played by steel pans in a carnival, the calypso uses a distinctive, syncopated rhythm pattern—short-long-short-long-long—over four beats in a measure.



◁ Steel pans

Originally made from oilcans, steel pans have circular dents in their heads that play different pitches when struck.

African music (sub-Saharan)

Clapping, singing, and dancing are part of everyday life in Africa. Improvised African music features syncopation, cross-rhythms, call-and-response, plentiful percussion, and varied singing styles. It is a highly influential genre and one that has been passed on by oral tradition.

▷ Djembe

This West African goblet-shaped drum is played with the hands. The body is carved from a hollowed trunk and is covered with goat skin.

